

Take Action

Make sure you have a plan to save for retirement:

1. Determine if your employer offers an employer-sponsored retirement account and if there is a match.
2. Plan to contribute enough to get the full amount of the match if one exists. If a match does not exist, it's still a good idea to contribute anyway to take advantage of the pre-tax benefits.
3. Next, create a plan to max out your contributions by increasing your contribution amounts by small percentage increments once a quarter or once every six months.
4. If your employer does not offer a plan or you are self-employed, look into the other plan types mentioned in this section to determine what will work best for you, and open up an account.
5. Determine how much you need to save for retirement and set your annual retirement account contribution goals.

CLEVER GIRL INVESTOR: MEET FANEISHA “FO” ALEXANDER

Meet Faneisha “Fo” Alexander. She is a Certified Financial Education Instructor (CFEI) and the founder of Girl Talk with Fo (girltalkwithfo.com). Faneisha successfully paid off over \$78,000 in debt in less than three years. Since becoming debt-free, she has built a six-figure investment portfolio before the age of 30. Her passion is to help other women learn to make and manage money to obtain their own financial freedom.

Q. You went from paying off \$78,000 of student loans to now focusing on investing and your own business. How did you do it and how long did it take you?

A. Paying off my student loans was a three-year journey that consisted of a debt repayment strategy, consistency, and sacrifice. From a strategic standpoint, I worked to increase my income by getting raises, selling unused items in my house, downsizing my lifestyle, and getting on a